



RENAISSANCE  
PREMIER REALTY GROUP

*Move with Strategy*

SENIOR TRANSITION · HOUSTON

# The Houston Senior Downsizing Checklist



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*Commitment beyond real estate  
— it's genuinely caring about you.*

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## THE CHECKLIST

## Sort Before You Pack, Not During

Sorting is deciding what matters. Packing is moving what's already been decided. Collapsing those into one rushed weekend is the most common mistake — it just moves the clutter to a smaller home. Use four categories, one item at a time:

- ☐ **Keep and bring** — it has a specific place in the next home
- ☐ **Give to a specific family member now** — not "eventually," now
- ☐ **Donate or sell** — someone else's daily use is better than a box in storage
- ☐ **Discard** — no sorting category, just gone

*If a decision genuinely can't be made in the moment, it goes in a small labeled holding box with a deadline — not into limbo.*

## Right-Size the Next Home First

- ☐ Get the exact square footage and room count of the next home before sorting anything
- ☐ Measure doorways, hallways, and elevators for large furniture pieces
- ☐ Make a floor plan sketch and decide what actually fits before deciding what to keep
- ☐ Confirm what's already provided (appliances, window coverings) so nothing is duplicated



## THE CHECKLIST

## Photograph and Let Go

- ☐ Photograph sentimental items that won't fit — the memory often outlasts the need for the object
- ☐ Record the story behind an item while photographing it, not just the item itself
- ☐ Offer photographed items to family before donating, on a short deadline

## Don't Skip the Paperwork Sort

Set these aside first, before the general sort even starts — they get lost in the shuffle precisely because they don't look sentimental or valuable in the moment.

- ☐ Deeds, titles, and mortgage documents
- ☐ Insurance policies (home, life, health, long-term care)
- ☐ Powers of attorney, medical directives, and estate planning documents
- ☐ Medical records and a current medication list
- ☐ Financial statements, tax returns (last 3 years), and safe deposit box keys



THE VENDOR DIRECTORY

# Vendors Worth Calling Before You Need Them

These are Fay's current top picks in each category, pulled from her full vetted vendor directory. For additional options in any category, the complete list lives at [faybrink.github.io/vendors.html](https://faybrink.github.io/vendors.html).

## Sorting & Disposal

### SENIOR MOVE MANAGER

## Lone Star Transitions

[lonestartransitions.com](https://lonestartransitions.com)

TOP PICK

### ORGANIZER

## Just Organized by Taya

832-271-7608 · [justorganized.com](https://justorganized.com)

TOP PICK

### ESTATE SALE COMPANY

## Blue Moon Estate Sales

832-614-8490 · [bluemoonestatesales.com](https://bluemoonestatesales.com)

TOP PICK



THE VENDOR DIRECTORY

# Movers, Storage & Last-Mile Disposal

MOVERS

TOP PICK

## 3 Men Movers

713-333-6683 · 3menmovers.com

STORAGE

TOP PICK

## Extra Space Storage

713-683-7979 · extraspace.com

DONATION / CHARITY PICKUP

TOP PICK

## DonateStuff.com — Purple Heart Program

713-685-5400 · donatestuff.com

JUNK REMOVAL

TOP PICK

## 1-800-GOT-JUNK

800-468-5865 · 1800gotjunk.com





THE VENDOR DIRECTORY

# Getting the Vacated Home Market-Ready

Once the home is empty, these are the categories that most affect how it shows — and how quickly it sells.

HANDYMAN

## City & Beyond

281-725-3418 · [cityandbeyond1.com](http://cityandbeyond1.com)

TOP PICK

DEEP CLEANING SERVICE

## COIT Cleaning

713-999-4527 · [coit.com](http://coit.com)

TOP PICK

MAID SERVICES

## Molly Maid

833-860-2987 · [mollymaid.com](http://mollymaid.com)

TOP PICK

## THE VENDOR DIRECTORY

# The Legal & Financial Side

This is the piece most downsizing checklists skip entirely — and it's often the most consequential. Handling it early, ideally before a transition is urgent, protects both the family's decisions and the home's equity.

SENIOR LIVING PLACEMENT ADVISOR

TOP PICK

## Senior Living Specialists Houston

713-240-6302 · seniorlivingspecialists.com

ELDER LAW ATTORNEY

TOP PICK

## Holland Elder Law Firm

713-970-1300 · hollandelderlawfirm.com

ESTATE PLANNING ATTORNEY

TOP PICK

## Katherine Boyd Law

832-586-6573 · katherineboydlaw.com

FINANCIAL / ESTATE PLANNER

TOP PICK

## Financial Synergies Wealth Advisors

713-623-6600 · financialsynergies.com

NOTARY PUBLIC

TOP PICK

## Jay's Mobile Notary

713-259-3290 · jaysmobilenotary.com



A NOTE FROM FAY



A senior transition is rarely just a real estate transaction — it's the sale of decades of a life, on a timeline that has to work for everyone involved. I've built my entire practice around handling that well: with the patience it deserves when there's time, and the speed it requires when there isn't.

If you're navigating this for yourself, a parent, or a client, I'd welcome the conversation — no pressure, no obligation.

BOOK A FREE CONSULTATION

*No pressure. No obligation. Just a conversation.*

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## Fay Brink

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